700 plus Shiites they are holding. At the same time I've urged that we approach Assad of Syria to go to Berri and tell him he can be a hero by releasing our people or he can be stubborn and we will begin some actions such as closing down the Beirut airport, closing Lebanon's harbors, etc., until he releases our people. This is all being staffed out now. I can agree to the need for a fig leaf but there also has to be threat of action (non-military).

June 26

N.S.C. and the newest hostage development: a light at the end of the tunnel. Berri (Assad's doing) has offered to let the hostages go to a western country's embassy in Beirut or Syria, supposedly to remain until Israel frees the Shiites it is holding. We prefer Syria and have no intention of letting them be held there. The Israelis are already planning to begin returning their prisoners. We want linkage between what they are doing and the release of the hostages. Berri released one today because of a heart condition. We are really optimistic. I've just learned that Berri owns a couple of markets and some oil stations here in the U.S. We might consider that a pressure point.

June 27

One hostage home and lots of Berri talk about the rest going to the French embassy in Beirut or Damascus. No further word. Berri has said he has no control or influence on the kidnap victims. Qaddafi is talking to Iran and Syria about a joint terrorist war against us . . .

June 28

[Trip to Chicago] . . . meeting with families of some of the hostages and one family of Rev. Jenco, one of the